

HOW TO SECURE YOUR LAPTOP

You can make your laptop sound an alarm when it is in the danger of getting stolen or losing data, free of cost. You can even recover or destroy your confidential data if the laptop is stolen



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Just having your laptop locked up in a laptop bag is not enough to deter thieves. You need to have certain measures in place to prevent the laptop from getting stolen, and also to ensure that the sensitive data stored on it does not go into the wrong hands.

You can secure your laptop both physically as well as digitally (through software). Here we'll talk about mainly the software-based security.

Physical security

Physical security devices deter theft of your expensive laptop hardware. A simple solution is a cable with a wrap-around loop at one end for tethering, and a lock at the other end that goes directly inside the laptop's

security slot. When the lock is in place, it is nearly impossible to remove the laptop without causing significant physical damage to it. So when using the laptop in a public place, you can secure the laptop by attaching it with a security cable to something immovable or to a heavy piece of furniture that can't be moved easily. A typical security lock with a cable is shown in Fig. 1.

Software-based laptop security

Like most security measures, cables for the laptop's physical

security are not infallible. Another effective method is to use an anti-theft protection software. Plenty of feature-packed software tools are widely available for laptop security, but their high cost prevents laptop users from using them. Fortunately, there are a number of free software too which come handy for the purpose. One such software is LAlarm, which sounds an alarm when your laptop is in the danger of getting stolen or losing data. It can recover as well as destroy the data on the laptop if the laptop is stolen.

LAlarm version 5.7 (refer Fig. 2) is available for Windows operating system (OS)-based portable computers. The software is free for personal use and can be downloaded from www.lalarm.com/en/Download.htm site. If you encounter any problem in



Fig. 1: Laptop fastened to a table with a security lock